

DISASTER RESPONSE FUNDING REQUESTS REJECTED

L.A. council declines to increase emergency office’s budget even after Palisades fire.

By MATT HAMILTON

Myriad calamities could hit the city of Los Angeles in coming years: Wildfires. Floods. Mudslides. Drought. And of course, the Big One.

Yet this month, L.A. leaders once again balked at dramatically increasing the budget of the city’s Emergency Management Department, even as the office coordinates recovery from the Palisades fire and is tasked with helping prepare for a variety of disasters and high-profile events, such as the 2028 Summer Olympics.

Facing a nearly \$1-billion budget shortfall, the L.A. City Council voted 12 to 3 last week to pass a budget that rejected the funding increases requested by EMD leaders to hire more staffers and fix broken security equipment around its facility.

The only budgetary increase for EMD will come through bureaucratic restructuring. The department will absorb the five-person Climate Emergency Mobilization Office, which Mayor Karen Bass had slated for elimination in her initial proposal to trim the budget deficit.

The funding allotment for EMD — with an operating budget of about \$4.5 million — puts the department short of similar big cities in California and beyond.

As a 2022 audit by then-City Controller Ron Galperin noted, San Diego (\$2.46), Long Beach (\$2.26) and San Francisco (\$7.59) all spent more per capita on emergency management than L.A., which then spent \$1.56 per resident. Whereas L.A. has a staff of roughly 30, New York, with more than double the population of L.A., has 200 people in its emergency management team, and Philadelphia, with a population less than half of L.A.’s, has 53.

The current leaders of EMD, General Manager Carol Parks and Assistant [See **Disasters**, A6]

A vandalism rampage in L.A.

An illegal downtown party leads to graffiti on businesses and more. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Test of a new free-speech law

Rights groups file briefs in court fight involving Blake Lively. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Teenage caddies earn big reward

Hardworking trio from L.A. learns golf in summer program and wins scholarships for college. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather

Low clouds clearing. L.A. Basin: 73/59. **B6**

Markets A9 Opinion Voices A10

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MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times



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A HOUSE, top, burns in Pacific Palisades in January. After the Palisades fire, mudslides in Malibu, middle, were triggered by a storm, above, in February.

Trump threatens state funds over trans athletes

President blasts Newsom, says he will cut federal dollars to California due to youth sports policy

By HANNAH FRY, HOWARD BLUME,
STEVE HENSON AND TARYN LUNA

President Trump on Tuesday threatened to cut federal funding to California if the state continues allowing transgender athletes to compete in women’s sports.

Trump blasted Gov. Gavin Newsom in an early morning post on Truth Social, saying the state under his leadership “continues to ILLEGALLY allow MEN TO PLAY IN WOMEN’S SPORTS.”

“I will speak to him today to find out which way he wants to go???” Trump said

of Newsom. “In the meantime I am ordering local authorities, if necessary, to not allow the transitioned person to compete in the State Finals. This is a totally ridiculous situation!!!”

The president’s post seemed to reference A.B. Hernandez, a Jurupa Valley High School junior who won the girls’ long jump and triple jump during the California Interscholastic Federation Southern Section Masters Meet over the weekend.

The California Interscholastic Federation — which oversees sports at more than 1,500 high [See **Athletes**, A5]

Was there more to their mom’s death?

LAPD suspects a drug overdose after two bodies are found. But relatives have doubts.

By RUBEN VIVES

The daughters of a U.S. Army veteran whose body was found in a homeless encampment on the edge of downtown are raising concerns about the Los Angeles Police Department’s handling of their mother’s case.

Lucrecia Macias Barajas, 46, was found dead May 12 by

one of her three daughters after she traced her mother’s cellphone to a large, tarp-covered shelter in a notorious Westlake cul-de-sac. Another lifeless body, that of an unidentified man, also was found inside, along with two live dogs, according to officials.

Video taken by a resident showed the daughter wailing on the ground after making the tragic discovery and later begging officers to remove her mother’s body.

The LAPD has characterized the death as a suspected drug overdose, and [See **Barajas**, A6]



JULIANA YAMADA Los Angeles Times

A DAUGHTER of Lucrecia Macias Barajas holds a photo of her mom, who once served in the U.S. Army.

Paramount sale bogged down after Trump suit

Critics say settling over edits to a ‘60 Minutes’ interview could be illegal payoff.

By MEG JAMES

One fateful October decision to trim two convoluted sentences from a “60 Minutes” interview with then-Vice President Kamala Harris has snowballed into a full-blown corporate crisis for CBS’ parent company, Paramount Global, and its controlling shareholder, Shari Redstone.

President Trump’s \$20-billion lawsuit — claiming “60 Minutes” producers deceptively manipulated the Harris interview to make her look smarter — has festered, clouding the future of Paramount and the company’s hoped-for \$8-billion sale to David Ellison’s Skydance Media.

The dispute over the edits has sparked massive unrest within the company, prompted high-level departures and triggered a Federal Communications Commission examination of alleged news distortion. The FCC’s review of the Skydance deal has become bogged down, according to people familiar with the matter who weren’t authorized to comment.

The agency, chaired by a Trump appointee, must approve the transfer of CBS television station licenses to the Ellison family for the deal to advance.

A lawsuit resolution, through court-ordered mediation, remains out of reach. And last week, three U.S. senators raised the stakes by suggesting, in a letter to Redstone, that a Trump settlement could be considered an illegal payoff.

Sens. Elizabeth Warren (D-Mass.), Bernie Sanders (I-Vt.) and Ron Wyden (D-Ore.) warned in their letter that any payment to Trump to gain favorable treatment by the FCC could violate federal anti-bribery laws. Paramount’s dealings with Trump “raises serious concerns of corruption and improper conduct,” the senators wrote.

“Under the federal bribery statute, it is illegal to corruptly give anything of value to public officials to influence an official act,” the senators said.

Redstone is desperate for the Paramount-Skydance deal to go through.

Her family’s holding company is cratering under a mountain of debt. Paramount’s sale to the Ellison family would provide the clan \$2.4 billion for their preferred shares — proceeds that would allow the Redstones to pay their nearly \$600 million in debt — and

remain billionaires.

Paramount, Skydance and a spokesperson for Redstone declined to comment.

While recusing herself from granular and final decision-making, Redstone has made it clear that she wants Paramount to settle with Trump, rather than wage an ongoing beef with the sitting president, according to people familiar with the matter but not authorized to discuss internal deliberations.

Figuring a way out of the dispute has divided the company, according to insiders.

For CBS News professionals, apologizing to Trump over routine edits of a lengthy interview is a red [See **Paramount**, A9]

Justices support school in T-shirt dispute

Court rejects student’s claim of free-speech right to wear an ‘only two genders’ message.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Tuesday turned down a middle-school student’s claim that he had a free-speech right to wear a T-shirt stating there are “only two genders.”

Over two dissents, the justices let stand a ruling that said a school may enforce a dress code to protect students from “hate speech” or bullying.

After three months of internal debate, the justices decided they would not take up another conservative culture-war challenge to progressive policies that protect LGBTQ+ youths.

Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. filed a 14-page dissent joined only by Justice Clarence Thomas. He said the case “presented an issue of great importance for our nation’s youth: whether public schools may suppress student speech because it expresses a viewpoint the schools disfavor.”

Liam Morrison, a seventh-grader from Massachusetts, said he was responding to his school’s promotion of Pride Month when students were encouraged to wear rainbow colors and posters urged them to “rise up to protect trans and gender-nonconforming students.”

Two years ago, he went to school wearing a black T-shirt that said “There are only two genders.”

A teacher reported him to the principal, who sent him home to change his shirt. A few weeks later, he returned with the word “censored” taped over the words “two genders” and was sent home again.

[See **Court**, A5]

Court won’t hear Apache challenge

The decision clears the way for a massive copper mine on a sacred site in Arizona. **NATION, A4**



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